

ANCHOR · SPLIT · PROSE

topic

Topic anchor inside a section. A horizontal cut: the topic above, the section's topics as a scale below.

Payback

Fourteen months blended, against a nine-month plan.

Cost to win

Lifetime value

Payback

The assumptions

Payback

Fourteen months blended, against a
nine-month plan.

CAC ÷ MONTHLY GROSS MARGIN · 14 COHORTS · FY26 ACTUALS

fact · topic fact — One flat canvas. The claim becomes the display line, the name a label on a rule, and a mono basis line states what the claim rests on.

Escalation paths

Three of the nine paths route to a team that no longer owns the service.

Intake

Triage

Ownership

Runbooks

On-call

**Escalation
paths**

Postmortems

Action tracking

Review
cadence

When NOT to reach for topic.

A section with one topic, or with ten

Below two there is no scale to draw and the track is suppressed, leaving a slide that is a `divider light` with extra chrome — use `divider light`. Past nine the track has ramped its labels down twice and still runs out of room; a section with ten topics is two sections, so split it with another `divider`. If what you want is the deck's contents rather than one section's, that is `agenda`.

When NOT to reach for topic.

A full sentence as the heading

The heading is also this topic's label in every sibling slide's track. A sentence reads as a headline here and overflows its column there. Short noun phrase; put the sentence in the claim.

More than one per two or three content slides

A topic anchor is a breath, not a separator. Firing it between every slide makes it chrome and costs it the authority that makes it work.

When NOT to reach for topic.

Carrying a fact that appears nowhere else

An anchor is deletable without losing information — the section proves the claim on the slides that follow. If the number lives ONLY on this slide, it is a `big-number`, not a `topic`.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`divider` — the boundary BETWEEN sections, rather than a topic inside one

`agenda` — the deck's sections, listed once, as a contents page

`big-number` — the metric IS the slide, not an anchor before the evidence